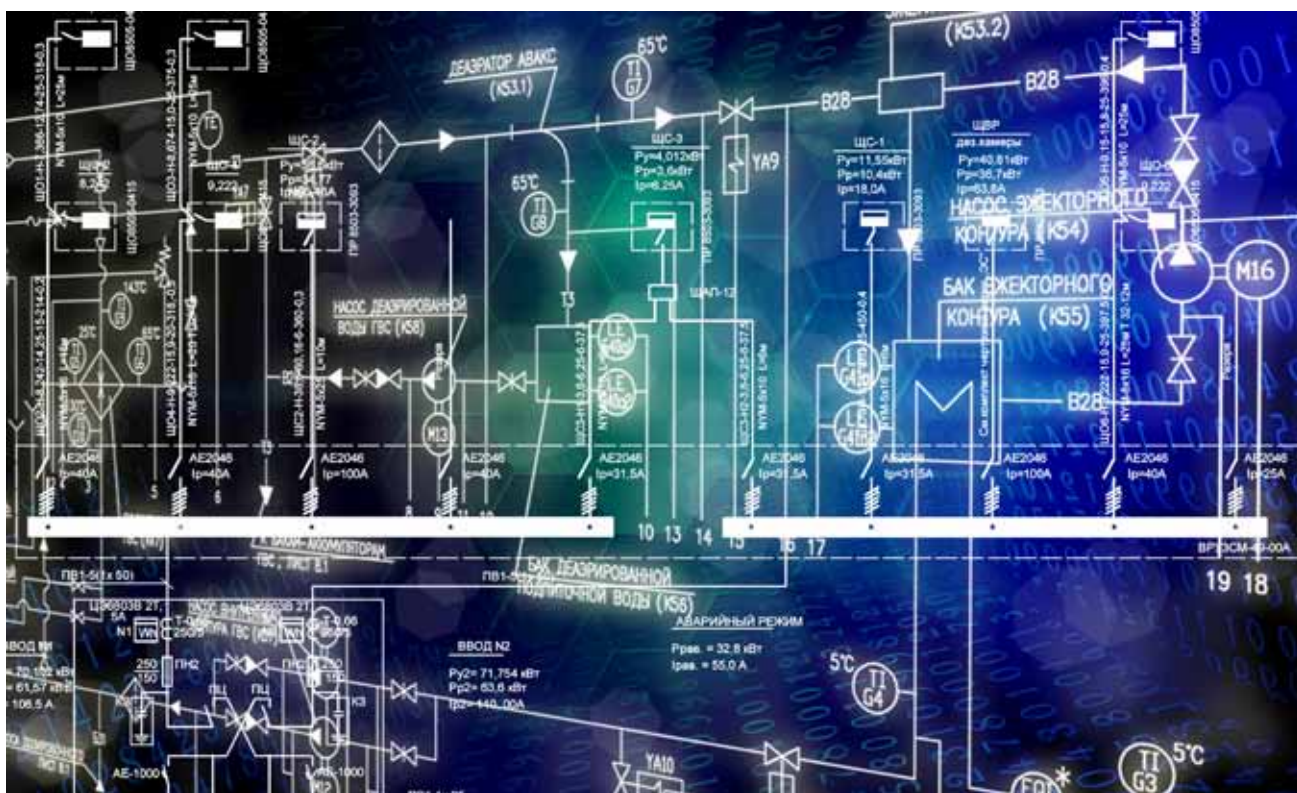


Why PRODUCTS For GLOBAL MARKETS Need To Meet Standards

Complying to standards calls for a structured approach. In every phase of the product development, impact of standard compliance has to be assessed and actions have to be taken. This is very important. If a list of the items to be checked is prepared, it will run into a book. Here is some guidance on the subject



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When products are designed there are three aspects that are critical: The product's usability, performance, and compliance to standards. All three aspects are focused on the users to ensure they get the best when they buy a product.

For example, let us say the product is a washing machine. The user interface of the product should be easy to use, intuitive, and consistent, so that no training is

needed for operating it. Second aspect is performance, where the washing machine has to meet all the product specifications and claims made by the manufacturer. Third is the compliance to standards.

Standards are drafted to address three aspects:

1. Safety of the user (both electrical and mechanical)
2. Use of environmentally safe manufacturing processes